

What the System Remembers: The Disagreement

系统记住了什么：分歧

Theme: 科学、技术与互联网 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The disagreement was about the **level** of the **result**. “If we **extend** the trial, the **wait** is **permanent**,” Maya said. “If we **pull** it back, the **current** of data will **drag** us to the start.” At the **end** of a long talk, four of the group held one view and the rest held another, and the period of the launch had already been extended twice.

The action they agreed on was small: **acquire** one more sensor, **restore** the old **lamp**, and **cap** the pipe that emitted the **raw carbon**. The **mask**, the **tissue**, and the **plain dot** on the screen were the only evidence in the room, and the **dim** light made the **skeleton** of the machine look like a creature.

A chemist in the **biochemistry** lab explained the **mechanics** of the failure: a **lag** in the **acceleration** of the reaction, an **explosive** mixture of **hydrogen** and **gasoline** vapour, and a **pitch** of the sensor that nobody had ever calibrated. Across the corridor, the **busy** lab and the quiet one were a **mile** apart in **length** but not in kind, and they had to get the answer together.

“You may not quit,” the officer said. “The **formality** of a signature is not a **cure**.” The **endless bounce** of the cursor, the bright **exit** sign, and the small dots that circulated on the screen: it was a **phenomenon** that none of the four could name.

They were asked to hold the line on one point only: nothing would be acquired, not one byte, without a written reason. At this **elevation**, with the **anchorage** of a hundred years of practice behind them, the answer was not going to be simple. One team would **recover**; one would not.

Perhaps the launch would be off for a season; perhaps for good. The development of the service and the safety of the people in it were on the same table, and the time had come to choose which one would pay. Nobody in the room wanted to be the one who said it first. Across the table, the four of them could not get past the same question, and the **end** of the period was still on.

中文翻译

分歧在于结果的层级。“如果我们延长试行，等待就变成永久的，”曼雅说，“如果我们把它撤回来，数据的潮流就会把我们拖回起点。”在一场漫长的谈话结束时，小组里四个人持一种看法，其余人持另一种，而发布的期限已经被延长了两次。

他们达成一致的行动很小：再取得一个传感器、修好那盏旧灯，并把那根排放生碳的管子盖上盖子。面具、薄纸，以及屏幕上那个平淡无奇的点，是屋里仅有的证据，而昏暗的灯光让机器的骨架看起来像一个生物。

生物化学实验室的一位化学家解释了失效的机理：反应加速中的一段滞后、氢与汽油蒸气的爆炸性混合物，以及一个从未被校准过的传感器倾角。走廊对面，忙碌的实验室和安静的实验室在长度上相隔一英里，在性质上却并非如此，而他们必须一起得到答案。

“你不可以辞职，”官员说，“签名的礼节不是一剂解药。”光标无休止地跳动、明亮的出口标志，以及屏幕上循环移动的小点：这是一种四个人都叫不出名字的现象。

他们被要求只在一个点上守住底线：任何东西都不能被取得，一个字节也不行，除非有书面的理由。在这样的高度上，身后有一个世纪实践的锚地，答案不会简单。一支队伍会恢复过来；另一支不会。

也许发布会停一个季度；也许是永久。这项服务的发展与其中人们的安全摆在同一张桌上，而选择谁付代价的时候到了。屋里没有人愿意做第一个说出这句话的人。桌子对面，他们四个人都绕不过同一个问题，而这个周期的终点仍然悬着。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
if if POS: conj	conj. 如果, 是否, 无论何时, 假设, 即使; n. 条件; [计] DOS批处理命令:根据所测试的条件决定是否执行另一条命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: conj. In case that; granting, allowing, or supposing that; —; introducing a condition or supposition; conj...
end end POS: n	n. 结束, 终点, 目标, 末端, 梢, 死亡, 残余; v. 结束, 终结, 终止; [计] 端; 结束 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. either extremity of something that has length; n. the point in time at which something ends; n. the concludi...
level 'levl POS: n	n. 水平, 水准, 平地; a. 同高的, 平坦的, 齐平的, 水平的; vt. 弄平, 夷平, 使同等, 瞄准, 对准; vi. 变平, 拉... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. height above ground; n. indicator that establishes the horizontal when a bubble is centered in a tube of li...
result ri'zʌlt POS: n	n. 结果, 成绩, 答案; vi. 产生, 结果, 致使; [计] 结果 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that results; v. issue or terminate (in a specified way, state, etc.); end; v. come about or follo...
wait weit POS: n	n. 等待, 等候; vt. 等候, 期待, 延缓, 伺候, 推迟; vi. 等, 等候, 耽搁, 伺候用餐; [计] 等待 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of waiting (remaining inactive in one place while expecting something); v. stay in one place and an...
pull pul POS: vt	vt. 拉, 拖, 拔, 牵, 撕开, 吸引; vi. 拉, 拖, 拔, 有吸引力; n. 拉, 拖, 拔, 拉力, 牵引力, 划船, 吸引 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of pulling; applying force to move something toward or with you; n. the force used in pulling; n. sp...
current 'kʌrənt POS: n	n. 涌流, 趋势, 流; a. 流通的, 现在的, 当前的, 流行的; [计] 当前的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a flow of electricity through a conductor; n. a steady flow of a fluid (usually from natural causes); a. occ...
mile mail POS: n	n. 英里, 很大距离; [机] 英里, 哩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unit of length equal to 1,760 yards or 5,280 feet; exactly 1609.344 meters; n. a large distance; n. an anc...
extend ik'stend POS: v	v. 扩充, 延伸, 伸展, 扩大; [计] 扩展 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make available; provide; v. reach outward in space; v. expand the influence of; v. open or straighten out; un...
length lenθ POS: n	n. 长度, 长, 期间, 一段; [计] 记录长度; 块长; 字长 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the linear extent in space from one end to the other; the longest dimension of something that is fixed in...
acquire ə'kwaɪə POS: vt	vt. 获得, 学到; [电] 目标锁定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. locate (a moving entity) by means of a tracking system such as radar; v. win something through one's efforts
busy 'bɪzi POS: a	a. 忙碌的, 热闹的, 没空的; vt. 使忙; vi. 忙碌; [计] 忙; 忙碌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. keep busy with; a. actively or fully engaged or occupied; s. overcrowded or cluttered with detail; s. crowded...
recover ri'kʌvə POS: vt	vt. 重新获得, 恢复, 复原, 拯救; vi. 痊愈, 复原, 胜诉; [计] 恢复 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. get or find back; recover the use of; v. regain a former condition after a financial loss; v. regain or make...
permanent 'pɜ:mənənt POS: a	a. 永久的, 不变的, 固定的, 持久的; n. 烫发; [计] 永久的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. continuing or enduring without marked change in status or condition or place; s. not capable of being rever...
drag dræg POS: n	n. 拖, 拖累; v. 拖累, 拖拉, 沉重缓慢地走, 拖动; [计] 拖动 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the phenomenon of resistance to motion through a fluid; n. something that slows or delays progress; n. somet...
restore ri'stɔ: POS: vt	vt. 回复, 恢复, 归还, 修补, 修复; vt. 还原; vi. 还原; [计] 还原; DOS外部命令:从备份盘中取回文件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. return to its original or usable and functioning condition; v. give or bring back; v. bring back into origin...
cap kæp POS: n	n. 盖子, 帽子; vt. 戴帽子, 覆盖, 胜过; vi. 脱帽致意; [计] 调用程序分析, 容量, 代码分析程序, 计算机辅助生产, 计... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tight-fitting headdress; n. a top (as for a bottle); n. something serving as a cover or protection; n. a fr...
phenomenon fi'nɒmɪnən POS: n	n. 现象, 迹象, 表现, 奇迹, 奇才; [化] 现象 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any state or process known through the senses rather than by intuition or reasoning; n. a remarkable develo...
quit kwɪt POS: vi	vi. 离开, 辞职, 停止; vt. 离开, 放弃, 使解除, 停止; n. 离开; [计] 结束, 退出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v put an end to a state or an activity; v give up or retire from a position; v go away or leave; v turn away fro...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
pitch pɪtʃ POS: n	n. 程度, 坡度, 顶点, 前倾, 倾斜, 投掷, 音高, 螺距, 节距, 摊位, 树脂, 沥青; vt. 投, 掷, 向前倾跌, 扎营, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property of sound that varies with variation in the frequency of vibration; n. (baseball) the act of th...
tissue ˈtɪʃu: POS: n	n. 薄的织物, 薄纱, 棉纸, 组织, 一套; [化] 组织 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. part of an organism consisting of an aggregate of cells having a similar structure and function; n. a soft...
plain pleɪn POS: n	n. 平原, 草原, 朴实无华的东西, 无格式; a. 简单的, 明白的, 平常的, 不好看的, 朴素的, 清晰的, 普通的, 平坦的, 十... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. extensive tract of level open land; a. not elaborate or elaborated; simple; a. lacking patterns especially i...
raw rɔ: POS: n	n. 擦伤处, 半成品; a. 生的, 未加工的, 生疏的, 不成熟的, 阴冷的, 刺痛的, 擦掉皮的; vt. 擦伤; [计] 写后读 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. informal terms for nakedness; s. having the surface exposed and painful; a. not treated with heat to prepare...
mask mæsk POS: n	n. 面具, 假面具, 掩饰, 石膏面模; vt. 戴面具, 掩饰, 使模糊; vi. 化装, 戴面具, 掩饰, 参加化装舞会; [计] 屏蔽; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a covering to disguise or conceal the face; n. activity that tries to conceal something; n. a protective cov...
carbon ˈkɑ:bən POS: n	n. 碳, 副本, 复写纸; [化] 碳 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an abundant nonmetallic tetravalent element occurring in three allotropic forms: amorphous carbon and grap...
lamp læmp POS: n	n. 灯; vt. 照亮; [计] 逻辑模拟分析系统 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an artificial source of visible illumination; n. a piece of furniture holding one or more electric light bu...
endless ˈendlɪs POS: a	a. 不停的, 无穷尽的, 无尽的; [机] 无端的, 环状的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. tiresomely long; seemingly without end; s. infinitely great in number; s. having the ends united so as to fo...
bounce baʊns POS: n	n. 跳, 跳跃, 弹力, 撞击; vi. 反跳, 弹跳; vt. 使跳回, 撞击; [计] 打回 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of a substance that is able to rebound; n. rebounding from an impact (or series of impacts); v. ...
exit ˈeksɪt POS: n	n. 出口, 退场, 离去, 去世; vi. 退出, 脱离, 去世; [计] 退出; DOS内部命令: 本命令用于退出当前的命令处理器(COMM... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an opening that permits escape or release; n. the act of going out; v. move out of or depart from; v. lose th...
gasoline ˈgæəsəlɪn POS: n	n. 汽油; [化] 汽油 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a volatile flammable mixture of hydrocarbons (hexane and heptane and octane etc.) derived from petroleum; ...
dot dɒt POS: n	n. 点, 圆点, 小数点, 小东西, 嫁妆; vt. 作小点记号, 加小点于; vi. 打上点; [计] 点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the shorter of the two telegraphic signals used in Morse code; v. scatter or intersperse like dots or studs...
circulate ˈsɜ:kjuleɪt POS: v	v. (使)流通, (使)循环, (使)传播 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to become widely known; v. cause be distributed; v. move through a space, circuit or system, returning...
cure kjʊə POS: n	n. 治疗, 治愈, 治疗法; vt. 治疗, 治愈, 改正, 腌制, 加工处理, 使硫化; vi. 受治疗, 被加工处理, 被硫化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. prepare by drying, salting, or chemical processing in order to preserve; v. make (substances) hard and impr...
hydrogen ˈhaɪdrədʒən POS: n	n. 氢; [化] 氢H-2 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a nonmetallic univalent element that is normally a colorless and odorless highly flammable diatomic gas; t...
explosive ɪkˈspləʊsɪv POS: n	n. 炸药, 爆破音; a. 易爆发的, 爆炸的, 暴躁的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a chemical substance that undergoes a rapid chemical change (with the production of gas) on being heated o...
dim dɪm POS: a	a. 暗淡的, 模糊的; vt. 使暗淡; [计] 数据解释模块 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. switch (a car's headlights) from a higher to a lower beam; v. become dim or lusterless; v. make dim or luste...
skeleton ˈskelətn POS: n	n. 骨骼, 骨瘦如柴的人, 梗概, 骨干, 残骸; a. 骨骼的, 概略的, 基层的, 骨干的; [计] 骨架 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something reduced to its minimal form; n. a scandal that is kept secret; n. the internal supporting structur...
emit ɪˈmɪt POS: vt	vt. 发出, 放射, 发表(意见等), 散发, 发行; [化] 放射 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. expel (gases or odors); v. give off, send forth, or discharge; as of light, heat, or radiation, vapor, etc.

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
elevation ˌeliˈveɪʃən POS: n	n. 海拔, 提高, 仰角; [计] 仰角 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the event of something being raised upward; n. angular distance above the horizon (especially of a celestia...
formality fɔː'mælɪti POS: n	n. 礼节, 拘谨, 正式手续; [化] 克式浓度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a requirement of etiquette or custom; n. a manner that strictly observes all forms and ceremonies; n. compli...
acceleration æk.səleɪ'reɪʃən POS: n	n. 加速, 促进, 加速度; [化] 加速度 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an increase in rate of change; n. the act of accelerating; increasing the speed; n. (physics) a rate of incr...
lag læg POS: n	n. 落后, 囚犯, 迟延, 桶板, 防护套; a. 最后的; vi. 落后, 蹒跚, 缓缓而行, 滞后; vt. 落后于, 押往监狱, 加上外... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. hang (back) or fall (behind) in movement, progress, development, etc.; v. throw or pitch at a mark, as with...
biochemistry ˌbaɪəʊ'kemɪstri POS: n	n. 生物化学; [化] 生物化学; 生化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the organic chemistry of compounds and processes occurring in organisms; the effort to understand biology...
anchorage 'æŋkərɪdʒ POS: n	n. 下锚, 锚地, 停泊税; [化] 固着; 固定; 锚定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the condition of being secured to a base; n. a fee for anchoring; n. a city in south central Alaska; n. place...
mechanics mi'kæniks POS: n	n. 机械学, 结构, 力学; [化] 力学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the branch of physics concerned with the motion of bodies in a frame of reference